# Console Control

*Quick reference — show automation for Allen & Heath dLive*

Discrete cues on a timecode ruler, fired at the console through MIDI Bridge, programmed against your own show recordings. Every shortcut can be changed in View → Keyboard Shortcuts (Ctrl+Opt+K), and every button shows its key when you hover over it. The full manual is the **Reference Manual**, beside this guide in the download and at dylanmaudio.com/guides/console-control-reference-manual.pdf.

## Transport & sync

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| **Space / Ctrl+Opt+Space / Home** | Play-stop / record armed reference tracks / go to start. |
| **Left / Right** | Move the playhead one snap step. 1…9 and 0 jump to regions 1…10 (Cmd+1…9: 11…19); G / Shift+G list the markers / regions; T asks for a timecode. |
| **SYNC button** | Next to record. SYNC **arms**, play **latches**, stop **disarms** — always. Dimmed = off · lit = armed · pulsing amber = awaiting code · green = locked · steady amber = freewheel. Click arms or disarms; right-click picks Internal / LTC / MTC, or Sync settings… for the inputs, freewheel, drift and offset. |
| **[ and ]** | Step the playhead through markers, region edges, audio clip edges and the project start. |
| **Loop** | Drag along the ruler's time row. Click the blue band to arm/disarm, double-click to clear. Wraps on the internal clock only. |
| **Scrub** | Grab the playhead line in the ruler; a plain ruler click locates. |
| **View** | Cmd+= / Cmd+– zoom, Cmd+0 fits the show, Cmd+Shift+0 the selection · Ctrl+Opt+Up / Down track height, Ctrl+Opt+F fits the tracks · Ctrl+Opt+G grid, Ctrl+Opt+M markers list. |

## Cues

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| **Insert strip** | U (unity) · –∞ (I) · V (value…) · M (mute) · slashed M (unmute, Shift+M) · S (scene…) · A (action…) — the keys are the letters on the buttons. Multi-selected tracks insert together, one undo step. |
| **One selection** | Click selects a cue · Cmd-click toggles more · a background drag's time selection selects everything it covers (its height picks the tracks; Cmd-drag adds). |
| **Move** | Drag any selected cue — the whole set moves with ghost previews. Scene/action cues drag by their small marker; the label text is not a click target. |
| **Nudge** | Opt+Left / Opt+Right by the amount selector: 1/5/10/25 frames, 1 second, or Beat × div. |
| **Snap** | Free · Frame · Grid (the lines you can see) · Beat (tempo grid at the note-value subdivision). |
| **Tracks** | Up / Down move to the previous / next track (Shift extends the selection) · L locks a track, Ctrl+Opt+L / Ctrl+Opt+U lock / unlock all · Opt+[ / Opt+] previous / next cue on the lane · Shift+S / Shift+A solo / arm a reference track. |
| **Esc** | Clears cue + time selection; a second Esc clears the loop. Also closes any dialog. |

## Fired vs pending

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| **Plain readout** | That value was actually transmitted to the console. |
| **Dot on the readout** | Resolved at the playhead but NOT sent (chase off, or moved without a conform). |
| **Conform Console** | Ctrl+Opt+C — transmits everything pending in one pass; usable live at any moment. |
| **CHASE** | Global button suspends all transmission (Shift+C); each lane's CHASE badge toggles that lane (C; applies across selected tracks). |

## Show day

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| **Preflight (Ctrl+Opt+P)** | Every before-doors check at once, with the exact reason anything fails. |
| **Show Mode (Cmd+Shift+L)** | Locks editing and undo. Huge timecode, sync, chase and bridge health, live track readouts — and what is coming next: the region you are in and its time left, then the next cues, markers and regions with countdowns (amber inside 10 s, red inside 3 s). |
| **Panic (Cmd+Shift+Esc)** | Always available, even in Show Mode. |

## Import a show recording

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| **Import Audio (Cmd+I)** | Up to 12 files. Roles are guessed from CONTENT: LTC / mix with embedded LTC / mix / click; chunked recordings (-001, -002…) join automatically. |
| **Offline conform** | Every span of continuous timecode is decoded and placed at its timecode — one clip per song on Mix and Click tracks, each outlined as a region. |
| **Rate mismatch** | The report offers “change the project to N fps and place” in one step. |
| **Media** | Files copy into the show bundle; 48 kHz copies are bit-identical. |

## Tempo & markers

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| **Detect BPM** | Select a click section → the tempo button → Detect. Each steady stretch gets its own tempo span, a ramp is followed beat by beat, and the grid is anchored ON the clicks; elsewhere is free time. |
| **Markers** | Opt+M at the playhead; Opt+Shift+M named. Lanes show/hide from the pills; double-click pills and labels on the ruler to edit. |
| **Regions** | Opt+R from the time selection; drag edges on the ruler; double-click to edit. Edit → Regions from Audio Clips outlines a track’s clips. |
| **List panel** | Editable markers / regions / tempo spans with per-lane colour. |

## Console data

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| **Show-file import** | File → Import Console Show File… (.tar.gz or Director CSV): scene NAMES (the only automated source), channel names + colours — matched by console address, cues untouched, one undo step. |
| **Sync from Console (Ctrl+Opt+R)** | Reads every channel’s name and colour from the desk through MIDI Bridge 1.1+, and shows what would change first; new channels can be added as tracks, nothing is deleted. One undo step. |
| **Scenes / Actions** | + Track also creates extra Scenes tracks (independent categories) and Actions tracks (auto-claims the next CC). The gear on an action lane opens its configuration. |

## Reference audio

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| **Mixer (Ctrl+Opt+X)** | Gain, pan, mute, solo and arm per reference track, plus the master. Under each strip: **EQ** and **CMP** open that processor (the master has **LIM** as well); Shift- or Opt-click switches it in or out. |
| **Processing** | Each track: EQ → compressor → fader. Master: EQ → compressor → fader → limiter, whose threshold drives the mix into its ceiling. The EQ and compressor add no delay; the limiter adds 1.5 ms while it is in. Settings save with the show and are in every export. |

## Licence

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| **Console Control menu → Licence…** | Also on Settings → App: the state, a key field with **Activate**, **Deactivate this Mac**, **Buy…**. Read when a show is opened or created, never mid-session. Free tier = 5 cues of each type, all transmitting. A lapsed licence opens 3 more times with a warning, then output is off until renewed. The beta works in full until its date. |

## Check for updates

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| **Console Control menu → Check for Updates…** | Also on Settings → App. Manual only — never at launch, never on a timer — and refused while the transport runs, a chase is armed or the show is in Show Mode. Nothing is sent but the app's name and version. |

## Cue list mode

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| **Settings → Sync → This show plays as** | **Cue list**: the show runs on GO instead of the transport (saved with the show). Cues within 0.5 s after a marker fire as one GO; cues stacked on one time fire together; the rest one by one. |
| **Keys** | **Return** or **Space** GO · **Shift+Return** or **Shift+Space** Back (the console returns to before the moment) · **Cmd+Shift+G** Jump to… · Up / Down in Show Mode move standby · **Opt+Space** plays the timeline. |
| **More** | A marker can **auto-follow** (edit the marker: seconds to the next moment). **On GO** in Settings can play the reference audio from the moment. Companion has GO, Back, Jump and Standby, with the standing moment as a variable. |

## Latency

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| **Calibrate… (Settings → Sync)** | **Measure** times a round trip to the console through MIDI Bridge (→ console lead). **Read device** takes the LTC input's latency from CoreAudio (→ timecode arrives late by). **Check by ear** loops a click against a channel's mute: **Earlier / Later** nudge the lead, **Keep** saves. |
| **Cues fire to the sample** | Each cue is armed on a timer at its exact time, less the lead; Beat snap keeps the beat's exact time between frames. |

## HPF and EQ lanes

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| **Right-click an input → Add HPF / EQ lanes…** | HPF in/out, HPF frequency (20 Hz–2 kHz) and each EQ band's gain (±15 dB). |
| **Value…** | Asks in Hz or dB; a frequency ramps evenly by octave. |

## Aux MIDI tracks

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| **+ Track → Aux MIDI track** | Cues to a plugin host or any MIDI device — SuperRack, LiveProfessor, a desk's MSC input. Each track sends to a **destination**: a virtual port the host sees as *Console Control - name*, or an existing MIDI output. Right-click the track for its lanes and destinations. |
| **Lanes** | **Single message** (PC with bank, CC, Note, MSC GO) · **Multi-message** (named states, as an Actions lane) · **Variable** (a CC the cues ramp) · **Piano** (notes with pitch, velocity, length) · **Echo** (follows a Scenes lane as Program Changes) · **Send BPM** (tap tempo and/or MIDI clock from the tempo map). |
| **Learn** | Press Learn in the host, then ■ on the lane — it sends the lane's message now. ■ in the Insert strip, **Opt+A**, or a double-click on the lane, inserts a cue. Piano lanes: the gear → **Open piano editor…** — click adds, drag moves, the right edge stretches, Delete removes, Up/Down transpose, Left/Right nudge. |

## Output

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| **Export Audio (Cmd+E)** | Stereo or mono master with LTC, master and LTC in one file, master only, or every reference track — over the selection, one region, or every region with audio. WAV 44.1–96 kHz at 16/24/32-bit, timestamped, or MP3. |
| **Recording** | Armed tracks capture to <Track>-001.wav (incrementing) at the timeline position. |
| **Save guard** | Close / New / Open / Open Recent / RPP import all warn before discarding changes; autosave interval in Settings. |

## The bridge line (bottom of the window)

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| **Green** | Console connected through MIDI Bridge (IP shown). |
| **Amber** | Bridge running, console unreachable — check the console IP in the bridge, the network, and MIDI-over-TCP on the console. |
| **Red** | Start the MIDI Bridge app. |

**Console Control never opens its own console connection — the bridge owns the console's single MIDI-over-TCP socket.**

## If something goes wrong

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| **Export log** | Click **Export log** in the panel footer. A diagnostics zip lands on your Desktop — this session's log, the previous one, and your settings. Send that zip with your report; nothing leaves your Mac unless you send it. |
| **What the log holds** | Your settings at launch and each change, the audio device and its buffer size, the show opened, saved and autosaved, every timecode lock and loss, every Conform, the bridge link and why it could not open, every message the app showed you. Every launch is logged automatically to **~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/Console Control/**; newest 20 launches kept. |
| **Send feedback** | Also in the footer — a short message straight to me, no email client needed. |

## What's new in v0.3.9

• Changed: the beta runs to 30 November 2026, a free month past Console Control 1.0's launch on 1 November. Install this build to get it: earlier betas stop sending to the console after 31 October.
• New: Allen & Heath SQ consoles. Settings → MIDI → Console chooses the console a show is for: dLive or SQ. On an SQ, Console Control drives faders and mutes on inputs, groups, auxes, matrices, FX sends and returns, LR, DCAs and mute groups, sends from inputs to auxes and FX sends and from groups to matrices, and recalls scenes 1–300. It needs MIDI Bridge 1.5.0 or later, set to the SQ: that version is next out, and until then the dLive is the console to use. Sync from Console reads the SQ's names and colours in one go, leaving out strips that still have the desk's own names. Actions and HPF / EQ lanes stay the dLive's for now, and latency Measure comes to the SQ later.
• New: HPF and EQ lanes on dLive input channels. Right-click an input track → Add HPF / EQ lanes… for HPF in/out, HPF frequency and each EQ band's gain. They work like the fader lane — insert, ramp, conform, chase — in their own units: Hz (a frequency sweeps evenly by octave) and dB. The EQ bands' frequency, width and type follow once they're measured on a desk.
• Changed: the menus are reorganised, as in the 1.0 release: new Cue, Markers, Track, Window and Help menus, and Settings is in the Console Control menu. No shortcuts changed. Cue → Value…, Scene…, Action… and Aux MIDI… ask for their value as their keys do. Help holds Keyboard Shortcuts, the Quick Reference, the MIDI log, Export Log and Send Feedback. Menus show only keys with Cmd or Ctrl; the single-letter keys work as before and are listed in Help → Keyboard Shortcuts.
• Changed: the audio engine inside the app is newer, and this beta is where it gets its road test. Audio devices with only inputs or only outputs now work; the app uses less memory with many clips; an interface with very many channels no longer risks a crash at launch; and audio conversion is about three times faster on Intel Macs.
• Fixed: a show whose session starts at 01:00:00:00 (or any time but zero) could not be chased: code 01:00:00:00 put the playhead an hour in and nothing fired. The chase places the code relative to the show's session start, and every timecode the app shows — the ruler, the readouts, the markers list, the cue list, the Companion deck — is the show's own. The session start is set in Settings → Sync; cues keep their place when it changes.